

Chapter IV – Review of related literature

- 4.1. Why do we conduct a review literature?
- 4.2. Reading
- 4.3. Note taking

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Doing a Literature Review

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Definitions and concepts of LR

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- ✧ Literature review is an **evaluative report of information found** in the literature related to the selected area of study.
- The review should **describe, summaries, evaluate, clarify** and **give a theoretical as well as an empirical base** for the research.
- ❖ Literature reviews **help researchers limit the scope** of their investigation, and they convey the importance to studying a topic to readers.

What is literature review?

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- Literature review is *not a compilation of every work* written about a topic.
- It is *not simply a list of sources reviewed* separately for their own merit.
- It is *not just a descriptive list of the material available*, or a *set of summaries*

A literature review is an account of what has been published on a topic by accredited scholars and researchers.

A literature gives an overview of;

- ❖ what has been said, **who the key writers are?**
 - ❖ What are the prevailing theories and hypotheses?
 - ❖ What questions are being asked? and
 - ❖ **What methods and methodologies are appropriate and useful.**
- The literature review **asks how similar and related questions have been answered before.**

Purpose

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Your purpose is to **convey to your reader what topic, and what their strengths and weaknesses are.**

- **Expands** the introductory chapter to address the questions raised
- Helps the researcher in the **interpretation of results or findings.**
- Helps the researcher **to outline the implications of his study**
- Helps to **further define** the research problem

How to organize a literature review?

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- *There are a number of ways of organizing a literature review. Here is one suggestion:*
- ***Introduction:** define the topic, together with your reason for selecting the topic. You could also point out overall trends, gaps, particular themes that emerge, etc.*
- ***B. Body:** this is where you discuss your sources. Here are some ways in which you could organize your discussion:*
- ***Chronologically:** for example, if writers' views have tended to change over time. There is little point in doing the review by order of publication unless this shows a clear trend;*

How to organize a literature review?.....

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- ***Thematically***: take particular themes in the literature;
- ***Methodologically***: here, the focus is on the methods of the researcher, for example, qualitative versus quantitative approaches.
- ***Conclusion***: summarize the major contributions, evaluating the current position, and pointing out flaws in methodology, gaps in the research, contradictions, and areas for further study.

Sources for Literature review

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□ *Sources for LR include*

- *Computer-based literature searches (www).*
- *Bibliographies such as those found at the end of the books, articles.*
- *Books, articles, newspapers, reports, etc.*
- *Statistics collected at the national, provincial, departmental levels.*
- *Studies conducted in the country or region.*
- *Theoretical works related to the topic.*

Basic Premises/Considerations

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It must provide a **historical background of the subject.**

□ It must **adequately present** any and **all relevant materials.**

showing:

- **Difficulty of the problem**

- **The research design**

- **Procedures**

- **Instruments**

- **Analysis employed**

Other rules of Thumb

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- **Cite those references** that deal with every key variable
- Pay more attention to articles dealing with **more than one variable**
- Cite references that deal with **similar or conceptually related variables**
- Your headings should reflect your major variables.

Questions that Guide for Reviewing Related Literature

- ☐ What is the research all about?
- ☐ What are the independent and dependent Variables?
- ☐ Who were the respondents?
- ☐ What was the research design?
- ☐ What kind of data analysis was employed?
- ☐ What were the major findings?
- ☐ What were the researcher's conclusions?
- ☐ How do these bits of information relate to other research reports or similar topics?

Most literature reviews suffer the following problems:

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- ❑ **Lacking organization, focus, and coherence**
- ❑ Repetitive and bulky
- ❑ Failing to cite influential papers
- ❑ Failing to keep up with recent developments
- ❑ Failing to critically evaluate cited papers
- ❑ Citing irrelevant or unimportant references

while selecting relevant literature, the reviewer should be conscious enough not to pick the outdated source and not to miss the useful ones

In general literature review should:

- ☐ **Provide a context for the research**
- ☐ **Justify the research**
- ☐ **Ensure the research hasn't that been repeated,**
- ☐ **Show where the research fits in to the existing body of knowledge**
- ☐ **Enable the researcher to learn from previous theory on the subject**
- ☐ **Illustrate how the topic has studied previously**
- ☐ **Highlight flaws/gaps in previous research**
- ☐ **Show that the work is adding to the understanding of knowledge of the field**
- ☐ **Help refine refocus or even change the topic**